

SOF NSO Science — Topic Deep-Dive: Food

For Ambar, Class III CBSE

1. Where our food comes from

All the food we eat comes from either **plants** or **animals**.

Food from plants

Plants give us the biggest part of our meals.

Type	What it is	Examples
Fruits	Sweet or juicy parts of plants	Mango, apple, banana, orange, guava
Vegetables	Leaves, roots, stems we eat	Spinach (palak), potato, carrot, onion
Grains (cereals)	Seeds of grass-like plants	Rice, wheat, maize, bajra
Pulses (dals)	Seeds of pod plants	Rajma, chana, moong, arhar
Spices	Added for taste and smell	Turmeric (haldi), chilli, ginger, black pepper

We also get **oil** (from mustard, groundnut), **sugar** (from sugarcane) and **tea** from plants.

Food from animals

Food	Animal that gives it
Milk	Cow, buffalo, goat
Egg	Hen (and other birds)
Honey	Bees
Meat / fish	Goat, hen, fish

Trap to remember: milk, egg and honey ALL come from animals. Honey is often mistaken as coming from flowers — but it is *made by bees*, so it is an animal food. Ghee, butter and cheese all come from **milk**.

2. Three kinds of food (why we eat)

Every food does a special job in our body.

Kind	Job	Examples
Energy-giving	Give us power to run, play, work	Rice, bread, chapati, potato, sugar, ghee, oil
Body-building	Help us grow and repair the body	Egg, milk, dal (pulses), fish, meat, cheese
Protective	Keep us healthy and fight diseases	Fruits and green vegetables (they have vitamins)

A quick way to remember: **carbohydrates** and **fats** give energy; **proteins** build the body; **vitamins and minerals** protect it.

3. Balanced diet

A **balanced diet** is a meal that has ALL three kinds of food in the right amount — energy-giving, body-building and protective — plus water.

A good Indian plate = **roti/rice (energy) + dal or egg (body-building) + sabzi and a fruit (protective)**.

If a food group is missing, our body suffers: - Only rice and bread → too little **protein and vitamins** (this is a very common exam question). - No fruits or vegetables → we fall sick more easily.

4. Cooked and raw food

Some foods we eat **raw** (uncooked): cucumber, tomato, carrot, most fruits, salad.

Some foods **must be cooked** before eating: raw rice, raw dal, wheat flour, potato. Cooking: - kills germs, - makes food soft and easy to digest, - makes it tastier.

Eating some raw fruits and salad is healthy because heat can destroy some vitamins.

5. Healthy eating habits

- Wash hands **before** eating.
 - Eat fresh, clean food; wash fruits and vegetables.
 - Chew food well; do not eat too fast.
 - Drink plenty of clean water.
 - Do not skip breakfast.
 - Eat less junk food (chips, cold drinks, too many sweets) — it makes us unfit.
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Common traps

The trap	The truth
"Honey comes from flowers/plants"	Honey is made by bees → it is an animal food
"Sugar is a body-building food"	Sugar gives energy , it does not build the body
"Fruits give the most energy"	Fruits are protective (vitamins); rice and roti give energy
"A plate of only rice is balanced"	It is missing protein and protective foods
"All food should be cooked"	Many fruits and salad are eaten raw
"Eggs come from cows"	Eggs come from hens ; cows give milk

High-frequency question types

1. **Source:** "Which food comes from an animal / a plant?"
 2. **Classify:** "Rajma and chana are examples of ____" → pulses.
 3. **Function:** "Egg is a ____ food" → body-building.
 4. **Balanced meal:** "What should be added to make this meal balanced?"
 5. **Odd one out:** rice, wheat, maize, **egg** (egg is the odd one — an animal food).
 6. **Cooked vs raw:** "Which must be cooked?" → raw rice/dal.
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Key facts checklist

- ☐ Food comes from plants and animals.
- ☐ Fruits, vegetables, grains, pulses, spices come from plants.
- ☐ Milk, egg, honey, meat, fish come from animals.

- ☐ Energy foods = rice, roti, potato, sugar, ghee.
 - ☐ Body-building foods = egg, milk, dal, fish.
 - ☐ Protective foods = fruits and green vegetables.
 - ☐ Balanced diet = all three kinds + water.
 - ☐ Only rice+bread → lacks protein and vitamins.
 - ☐ Wash hands before eating; eat fresh food.
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Quick drill (10 questions)

1. Honey is made by which animal?
2. Rajma and chana are examples of ____.
3. Which food gives us the most energy: rice or orange?
4. Egg is an energy / body-building / protective food?
5. Fruits and vegetables are called ____ foods.
6. Name one food we usually eat raw.
7. Which food must be cooked before eating: cucumber or rice?
8. A meal of only rice and bread lacks ____.
9. Butter and ghee are made from ____.
10. What should we do before eating food?

Answers: 1. Bees 2. Pulses 3. Rice 4. Body-building 5. Protective 6. Cucumber/tomato/salad (any raw one) 7. Rice 8. Proteins and vitamins 9. Milk 10. Wash our hands